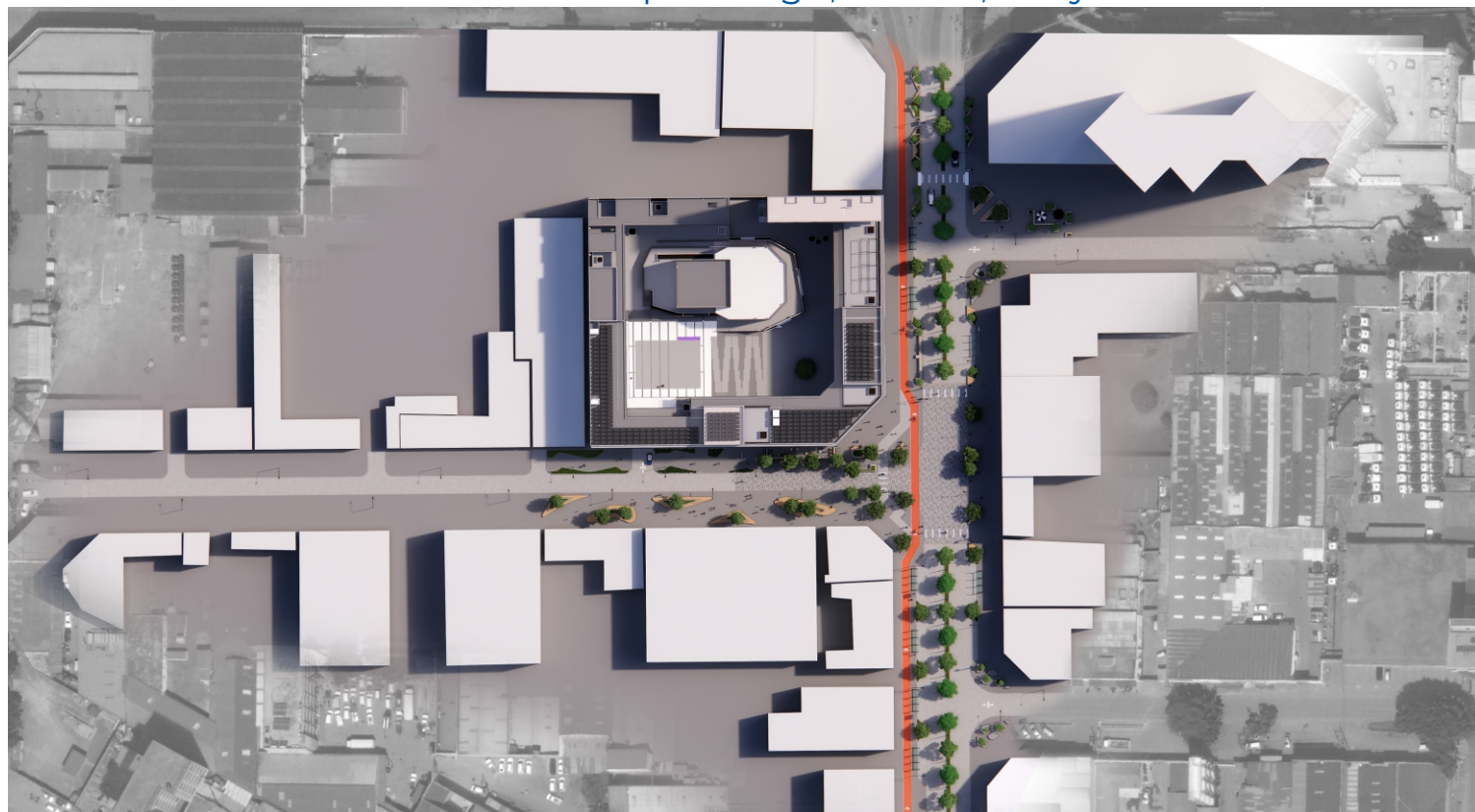


The GoDown Arts Centre Streetscape Design, Nairobi, Kenya



SERVICES PROVIDED

Urban Design

PROJECT TYPE

Masterplanning / Urban Design

LOCATION

Nairobi, Kenya

YEAR

2016

STATUS

Design Concept

Concept Design for the streetscape adjacent the future GoDown Arts Centre in Nairobi Industrial Area.

As part of the redevelopment of the GoDown Arts Centre, the first major arts centre in Kenya, we have been assigned to design the neighbouring streets Dundori and Dunga Road in the Nairobi Industrial Area. The design aims to seamlessly integrate the cultural centre and the surrounding streets, creating flexible spaces, promote and prioritize non-vehicular movement, and increase the amount of greenspace.

Streets are important components in the overall public space network. The streets are a shared public resource, and must cater for a multitude of activities, uses, and users. With the new arts centre being developed, the surrounding streets must cater for changes in user behaviour and better accommodate public use, in particular walking and cycling.

Core to the design is flexibility and multi-use. This to enable and accommodate a wider range of uses and activities during different hours of the day, or different days of the week. The design gives priority to pedestrian movement with wide and unobstructed footpaths along the full length of the streets linked to raised pedestrian crossings. In addition, adequate space is allocated for vendors and kiosks, public transport stops, drop off zones and bicycle parking - activities which commonly encroaches on walkways and pushing pedestrians into the carriageway. Rain gardens are introduced for storm water management, also adding greenery to the streetscape in addition to tree planting.

The project is part of the global HerCity programme, an UN-Habitat initiative, which aims to actively engage girls and young women in the planning and design process. More than 40 girls and young women have actively participated in the project, providing their unique input and insight of their experience of the streets as well as their suggestions on how to improve the spaces for the benefit of all.

